

Portfolio Website Design Guidelines

Visual-First Approach with Minimal Custom CSS

Color Palette

CSS

```
/* Only essential custom properties needed */
:root {
  --accent-lime: #ccff00;
  --accent-orange: #ff8c42;
}
```

Core Colors (Tailwind Classes)

- **Background:** `bg-black` - Pure black foundation
- **Text:** `text-white` - Clean white typography
- **Primary Accent:** `text-lime-400` or custom `--accent-lime` - Bright lime for CTAs
- **Secondary Accent:** custom `--accent-orange` - Warm orange for project highlights
- **Grays:** `text-gray-100` to `text-gray-900` - Neutral spectrum

Typography (Tailwind First)

Font Setup

html

```
<!-- Include Inter font -->
<link href="https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Inter:wght@300;400;500;600;700;800;900&display=swap" rel="stylesheet">
```

Typography Scale

- **Hero:** `text-6xl lg:text-8xl font-extrabold leading-tight tracking-tight`
- **Section Headers:** `text-3xl lg:text-5xl font-bold leading-tight`
- **Body Text:** `text-lg font-normal leading-relaxed`
- **Small Text:** `text-base font-normal`
- **Captions:** `text-sm font-light`

Layout System (Pure Tailwind)

Containers

html

```
<div class="max-w-6xl mx-auto px-6 lg:px-8">
  <!-- Content -->
</div>
```

Spacing (8px Base Unit)

- **Sections:** `py-32 lg:py-40`
- **Cards:** `p-8`
- **Elements:** `mb-6`, `mt-8`, `gap-6`
- **Large Gaps:** `gap-12`, `space-y-16`

Grid Systems

html

```
<!-- 12 Column Grid -->
<div class="grid grid-cols-1 lg:grid-cols-12 gap-6">
  <div class="col-span-1 lg:col-span-4">...</div>
  <div class="col-span-1 lg:col-span-8">...</div>
</div>

<!-- Services Grid -->
<div class="grid grid-cols-1 md:grid-cols-2 lg:grid-cols-3 gap-8">
  <!-- Service cards -->
</div>
```

Component Patterns

Buttons

html

```
<!-- Primary Button -->
```

```
<button class="bg-lime-400 text-black font-semibold px-8 py-4 rounded-xl  
  hover:bg-lime-300 hover:-translate-y-1 hover:shadow-xl  
  hover:shadow-lime-400/30 transition-all duration-300  
  inline-flex items-center gap-2">
```

Get In Touch

```
</button>
```

```
<!-- Secondary Button -->
```

```
<button class="border-2 border-white text-white font-semibold px-8 py-4 rounded-xl  
  hover:bg-white hover:text-black hover:-translate-y-1  
  transition-all duration-300 inline-flex items-center gap-2">
```

View Work

```
</button>
```

Cards

html

```
<!-- Project Card -->
```

```
<div class="bg-gray-800 border border-gray-700 rounded-2xl p-8  
  hover:-translate-y-2 hover:shadow-2xl hover:border-gray-600  
  transition-all duration-300 group">
```

```
<!-- Card content -->
```

```
</div>
```

```
<!-- Service Card -->
```

```
<div class="bg-gray-800 border border-gray-700 rounded-2xl p-8  
  hover:-translate-y-2 hover:border-lime-400 hover:shadow-xl  
  hover:shadow-lime-400/10 transition-all duration-300">
```

```
<!-- Service content -->
```

```
</div>
```

Section Templates

Hero Section

html

```

<section class="min-h-screen flex items-center justify-center text-center px-6">
  <div class="max-w-4xl mx-auto space-y-8">
    <!-- Hero content with graphics focus -->
    <div class="w-16 h-1 bg-lime-400 mx-auto"></div>
    <h1 class="text-6xl lg:text-8xl font-extrabold leading-tight">
      Visual<br><span class="text-lime-400">Designer</span>
    </h1>
    <!-- More graphics, less text -->
  </div>
</section>

```

Services Section (Graphics Heavy)

html

```

<section class="py-32 px-6">
  <div class="max-w-6xl mx-auto">
    <!-- Icon-focused service cards -->
    <div class="grid grid-cols-1 md:grid-cols-3 gap-8">
      <div class="text-center space-y-6">
        <!-- Large SVG icon (80x80px minimum) -->
        <div class="w-20 h-20 mx-auto text-lime-400">
          <!-- Icon SVG -->
        </div>
        <h3 class="text-2xl font-bold">Service Name</h3>
        <p class="text-gray-400">Brief description</p>
      </div>
    </div>
  </div>
</section>

```

Portfolio Grid

html

```

<section class="py-32 px-6">
  <div class="max-w-7xl mx-auto">
    <!-- Masonry-style project grid -->
    <div class="columns-1 md:columns-2 lg:columns-3 gap-8 space-y-8">
      <div class="break-inside-avoid">
        <div class="relative overflow-hidden rounded-2xl group">
          
          <div class="absolute inset-0 bg-black/40 opacity-0 group-hover:opacity-100
            transition-opacity duration-300 flex items-center justify-center">
            <button class="bg-lime-400 text-black px-6 py-3 rounded-lg font-semibold">
              View Project
            </button>
          </div>
        </div>
      </div>
    </div>
  </div>
</div>

```

Visual Hierarchy Guidelines

Content Ratios (Graphics vs Text)

- **70% Visual Elements:** Images, icons, graphics, white space
- **30% Text Content:** Essential copy only
- **Hero:** Large typography as graphic element
- **Services:** Icon-first approach
- **Portfolio:** Image-dominant grid
- **Contact:** Accent color background with minimal form

Animation Classes

html

```
<!-- Scroll animations -->
<div class="opacity-0 translate-y-8 transition-all duration-700 ease-out"
  data-aos="fade-up">
  <!-- Content -->
</div>

<!-- Hover effects -->
<div class="hover:-translate-y-2 hover:scale-105 transition-transform duration-300">
  <!-- Interactive element -->
</div>
```

Brand Voice Through Visuals

Visual Communication

- **Confident:** Bold typography, strong contrasts
- **Professional:** Clean grids, consistent spacing
- **Minimal:** Generous white space, selective color use
- **Modern:** Subtle animations, rounded corners

Content Strategy

- **Hero:** Personal brand statement (1-2 lines max)
- **Services:** Icon + title + 1 sentence
- **Portfolio:** Project name + category only
- **Testimonials:** Quote + name + company logo
- **Contact:** CTA + form (minimal fields)

Responsive Patterns

Mobile-First Classes

html

```
<!-- Typography scaling -->
<h1 class="text-4xl md:text-6xl lg:text-8xl">

<!-- Grid responsive -->
<div class="grid grid-cols-1 md:grid-cols-2 lg:grid-cols-3">

<!-- Spacing adjustments -->
<section class="py-16 md:py-24 lg:py-32">

<!-- Container padding -->
<div class="px-4 md:px-6 lg:px-8">
```



Implementation Notes

Minimal Custom CSS Required

Only add custom properties for:

- Accent colors not in Tailwind
- Complex animations
- Brand-specific values

Tailwind Config Extensions

```
js

// tailwind.config.js
module.exports = {
  extend: {
    colors: {
      'accent-lime': '#cfff00',
      'accent-orange': '#ff8c42'
    },
    fontFamily: {
      'sans': ['Inter', 'system-ui', 'sans-serif']
    }
  }
}
```

Performance Optimizations

- Use `aspect-ratio` utilities for consistent image dimensions

- Implement `loading="lazy"` for images
 - Use CSS Grid and Flexbox for layouts
 - Minimize custom CSS to reduce bundle size
-

This approach prioritizes visual impact while maintaining clean, maintainable code using Tailwind's utility-first methodology.